

PSYCHOLOGY OF LANGUAGE (LING/PHIL/PSY 341)

INSTRUCTOR: Amy Asma
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OFFICE HOURS: FLEXIBLE (Available by Appointment)

D2L COURSE WEBSITE

The syllabus, readings, and all relevant assignments and quizzes will be posted on d2l, as will weekly announcements and other important information. You must have regular and reliable access to our website in order to participate fully in this class. Please make a point of checking the website daily. One quick check may save you time in other ways!

READINGS

The readings for this course (some recommended, some optional) are freely available to you on d2l and are largely taken from Hoff, E. (2014). *Language Development*, 5th Ed. Cengage Learning. Please note that the readings support the video lectures rather than the other way around. Study from the video lectures and slides first and foremost and use the readings as backup.

COURSE DESCRIPTION, OBJECTIVES & OUTCOMES

Audience: This course is an upper division course on language development offered by the Linguistics Department. It is an elective for students from a variety of disciplines, including Linguistics, NSCS, Psychology, and Speech, Language, & Hearing Sciences. We make every effort to make the course accessible to students from all backgrounds, but this is a course about language, and for some, this may be the first time you've thought about language in the complex ways that are needed in order to understand how it is acquired. If you fall in the latter category, you may need to put in some extra effort to learn new terms and definitions (all will be provided to you, and all have to do with the "atoms" of language).

Objectives: The course is designed around the fundamental question of how children learn language. After decades of study on this topic, we have answered many questions as to how this essential task is completed, yet other aspects of the language acquisition process are still a mystery. In this class we will consider many types of data that will allow us to examine what children know about language, when and how such knowledge comes into play, and what theories have been offered to explain the complexities of language development. We will also consider the methodologies that allow us to test children, and even very young babies, especially at stages when they cannot speak for themselves.

At the end of the course, successful students will be able to answer the following questions:

- How do children learn the sound system of their native language and then learn to map sounds onto meaning?
- How do children learn to combine parts of words to create longer words?
- How do children figure out how to combine words to create sentences?
- What is the link between brain, mind, and language?
- What challenges do blind or deaf children face in learning language? Or children with language delay or disorders?
- How and how well do children learn a second (third, etc.) language?

Outcomes: In addition, successful students will also learn how to:

- Analyze, assess, and compare language data across children specific to each stage of language development
- Describe, discuss, and explain common misconceptions about language and how it is acquired (#3)
- Summarize and assess theories of language development in their ability to address key issues in acquisition

COURSE REQUIREMENTS AND GRADING

<u>CATEGORIES</u>	<u>TOTAL POINTS</u>
Discussion Posts	30
Quizzes	50
Project	20

<u>SCALE</u>
90% = A
80% = B
70% = C

TOTAL POSSIBLE POINTS	100
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60% = D
<60% = E

DESCRIPTION OF ASSIGNMENTS

Participation: Your participation grade is based on your *participation in discussion posts*. You have to take part in weekly discussions. You will both post your own views and reply to your peers to get full grade.

Quizzes: To ensure you are following the course material, you are required to complete weekly quizzes. All quizzes will be administered over d2l and will consist of objective-style questions, such as true/false, multiple choice, matching, blanks and multi-select. You will not be allowed to retake the quizzes.

Assignment: You will only be given one assignment at the end of the course. It will be of 20 points.

Exams: There are no exams.

SCHEDULE A MEETING WITH THE INSTRUCTOR

If you want to schedule a meeting, you should email me and together we can figure out a time that works best depending on our schedules.

SCHEDULE (SUBJECT TO CHANGE)

WEEK	DATE	TOPIC	QUIZZES	DISCUSSIONS	ASSIGNMENT
1	Mar 16-22	Introduction			
	Saturday		Q 1	DP1	
2	Mar 23-29	Phonological Development			
	Saturday		Q 2	DP2	
3	Mar 30-Apr 5	Lexical Development			
	Saturday		Q 3	DP3	
4	Apr 6-12	Development of Syntax & Morphology			
	Saturday		Q 4	DP4	
5	Apr 13-19	Biological Bases of Language.			
	Saturday		Q 5	DP5	
6	Apr 20-26	Childhood Bilingualism & Language in Schools			
	Saturday		Q 6	DP6	
7	Apr 27-May 3	Sentence Comprehension & Production			
	May 6th				Final Project

FURTHER EXPECTATIONS

Course Policies: Students are expected to abide by all university policies regarding attendance, academic integrity, and codes of conduct. For details, please see: <https://academicaffairs.arizona.edu/syllabus-policies>.

Late Policy. Each student is expected to complete all assignments (exercises, exams, discussions) by the posted due dates. It is your responsibility to note when assignments are due and to submit them at the appropriate time in the appropriate format and via the appropriate venue. Assignments will close by the date/time indicated on d2l. Remember, the dates/times listed are “end dates”, NOT “start dates” (especially relevant for quizzes and exams). For all assignments, you have multiple days to complete them and a missed due date due to poor planning does not comprise a valid excuse for accommodation. Assignments and quizzes will not be accepted late and/or cannot be made up except under circumstances already recognized by UA Policy (see “Course Policies” above). If you miss coursework for any other reason, you will lose all points for that assignment unless prior arrangements have been made.

Technical Issues. If you have questions or concerns about d2l, there are university resources available to help you. If you experience a technical problem that is beyond your control (system shut-downs, network interruptions, etc.), please

notify us as soon as possible via email and submit a problem to the d2l team as promptly as possible (<http://help.d2l.arizona.edu>, click on “Report a Problem”).

Course Notes. Students should be aware that course lectures and slides, and any other associated materials are copyrighted to me and/or your textbook authors. This includes student notes or summaries that substantially reflect our lectures or materials. These materials are made available only for personal use by students, and students may not distribute or reproduce the materials for commercial purposes without our express written consent. Violation of our copyright violates the Code of Academic Integrity and may result in course sanctions.

Performance. Although students are expected to participate fully in this class and to complete all assignments on time, these achievements alone are not sufficient to pass this course. To pass this course, you *must* demonstrate that you have mastered the course concepts presented this term. Students who wish to earn an ‘A’ must demonstrate superior mastery of course concepts throughout their work this semester.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Absence & Class Participation

The UA’s policies concerning Class Attendance and Participation is available at:
<https://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/courses-credit/courses/class-attendance-participation>.

The UA policy regarding absences for any sincerely held religious belief, observance or practice will be accommodated where reasonable, <http://policy.arizona.edu/human-resources/religious-accommodation-policy>. The calendar of religious holidays can be found at <https://registrar.arizona.edu/calendar-religious-holidays>.

Absences for groups of more than three students that are pre-approved by the UA Dean of Students (or Dean Designee) will be honored. See: <http://policy.arizona.edu/employmenthuman-resources/attendance>.

Threatening Behavior Policy

The UA Threatening Behavior by Students Policy prohibits threats of physical harm to any member of the University community, including to oneself. See <http://policy.arizona.edu/education-and-student-affairs/threatening-behavior-students>.

Accessibility & Accommodations

At the University of Arizona, we strive to make learning experiences as accessible as possible. If you anticipate or experience barriers based on disability or pregnancy, please contact the Disability Resource Center (520-621-3268, <https://drc.arizona.edu/>) to establish reasonable accommodations.

See <http://drc.arizona.edu/instructors/syllabus-statement>.

Code of Academic Integrity

Students are encouraged to share intellectual views and discuss freely the principles and applications of course materials. However, graded work/exercises must be the product of independent effort unless otherwise instructed. Students are expected to adhere to the UA Code of Academic Integrity as described in the UA General Catalog. See: <https://deanofstudents.arizona.edu/policies/code-academic-integrity>.

Nondiscrimination & Anti-Harassment

The University of Arizona is committed to creating and maintaining an environment free of discrimination. In support of this commitment, the University prohibits discrimination, including harassment and retaliation, based on a protected classification, including race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, veteran status, sexual orientation, gender identity, or genetic information. For more information, including how to report a concern, please see <http://policy.arizona.edu/human-resources/nondiscrimination-and-anti-harassment-policy>.

Safety on Campus & in the Classroom

For a list of emergency procedures for all types of incidents, please visit the website of the Critical Incident Response Team (CIRT): <https://cirt.arizona.edu/case-emergency/overview>.

Also watch the video available at https://arizona.sabacloud.com/Saba/Web_spf/NA7P1PRD161/common/learningeventdetail/crtfy000000000003560.

Subject to Change Statement

Information contained in the course syllabus, other than the grade and absence policy, may be subject to change with advance notice, as deemed appropriate by the instructor; see <http://policy.arizona.edu/faculty-affairs-and-academics/course-syllabus-policy-undergraduate-template>.

*For co-convened 400/500-level classes, the instructor may use a single syllabus for the jointly convened class or separate syllabi for the graduate and undergraduate offerings. If a single syllabus is used, it must meet the requirements of both the Undergraduate and Graduate Syllabus Policies and must clearly distinguish between graduate and undergraduate requirements and workload expectations.

The following text is not required to be included on syllabi, but faculty are highly encouraged to include it to increase awareness of the important resources and safety information it describes.

Campus Pantry

Any student who has difficulty affording groceries or accessing sufficient food to eat every day, or who lacks a safe and stable place to live and believes this may affect their performance in the course, is urged to contact the Dean of Students for support. In addition, the University of Arizona Campus Pantry is open for students to receive supplemental groceries at no cost. Please see their website at: campuspantry.arizona.edu for open times.

Additional Resources for Students

UA Academic policies and procedures are available at <https://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/all>.

Campus Health

<http://www.health.arizona.edu/>

Campus Health provides quality medical and mental health care services through virtual and in-person care.

Phone: 520-621-9202

Counseling and Psych Services (CAPS)

<https://health.arizona.edu/counseling-psych-services>

CAPS provides mental health care, including short-term counseling services.

Phone: 520-621-3334

The Dean of Students Office's Student Assistance Program

<https://deanofstudents.arizona.edu/support/student-assistance>

Student Assistance helps students manage crises, life traumas, and other barriers that impede success. The staff addresses the needs of students who experience issues related to social adjustment, academic challenges, psychological health, physical health, victimization, and relationship issues, through a variety of interventions, referrals, and follow up services.

Email: DOS-deanofstudents@arizona.edu

Phone: 520-621-7057

Survivor Advocacy Program

<https://survivoradvocacy.arizona.edu/>

The Survivor Advocacy Program provides confidential support and advocacy services to student survivors of sexual and gender-based violence. The Program can also advise students about relevant non-UA resources available within the local community for support.

Email: survivoradvocacy@arizona.edu

Phone: 520-621-5767

Preferred Name & Pronoun

This course affirms people of all gender expressions and gender identities. If you prefer to be called a different name than what is on the class roster, please let me know. Feel free to correct instructors on your preferred gender pronoun. If you have any questions or concerns, please do not hesitate to contact me directly in class or via email (instructor email). If you wish to change your preferred name or pronoun in the UAccess system, please use the following guidelines:

Preferred name: University of Arizona students may choose to identify themselves within the University community using a preferred first name that differs from their official/legal name. A student's preferred name will appear instead of the person's official/legal first name in select University-related systems and documents, provided that the name is not being used for the purpose of misrepresentation. Students are able to update their preferred names in UAccess.

Pronouns: Students may designate pronouns they use to identify themselves. Instructors and staff are encouraged to use pronouns for people that they use for themselves as a sign of respect and inclusion. Students are able to update and edit their pronouns in UAccess.

More information on updating your preferred name and pronouns is available on the Office of the Registrar site at <https://www.registrar.arizona.edu/records-enrollment/personal-information/updating-personal-information>.

Diversity & Inclusion. Inclusive Excellence is a fundamental part of the University of Arizona's strategic plan and culture. As part of this initiative, the institution embraces and practices diversity and inclusiveness. These values are expected, respected and welcomed here. This course supports elective gender pronoun use and self-identification; any public rosters or names indicating such choices will be updated throughout the semester, upon student request. As the course includes peer discussions, it is vitally important for us to create an educational environment of inclusion and mutual respect.

Students Facing Exceptional Circumstances. If exceptional circumstances arise or are anticipated during the term, such as chronic illness, trauma, or an emergency with unforeseen and long-term impacts, please see the notices above regarding basic needs and accessibility and accommodations. You may also contact the [Dean of Students](#) office (520-621-7057), which provides support, and connections to appropriate services, for students. The Dean of Students can also act as a liaison for you with your professors and supervisors. The Dean of Students Office is located in the Robert L. Nugent Building, Room 100. If accommodation in this course is needed due to exceptional circumstances, official recognition of your situation must be provided in order to negotiate any change of schedule for any course components.

Adding After the 1st Day of Class. Provided you register within the appropriate time-frame and/or have instructor approval, you are welcome to join the course late. However, please be aware that you may have missed assignments and deadlines that your teaching team is *not* obligated to adjust. While adding after the first day will not prevent you from earning an excellent grade, it is not valid to assume that you can add late without incurring possible costs – regardless of the reason for your late admission to the course. You are responsible for learning about the material you missed because you added the class late, and you are responsible for working through the remaining items in the course calendar in order to earn the grade you hope to achieve this semester.

Material Offensive to Some. Some of the course material will consider the genetic and biological underpinnings of language.